The Amir, betrayed by his own forces, was heartbroken.

> All his friends he saw become strangers to him
> He became sunk in anxiety for his own cause
>
> As the poet Sa'adi said, 'When you see that your friends are no longer friendly
> Look upon flight from the field as your gain'
>
> So he plucked out of his heart all thoughts of war
> From weapons, arms and those things dear to him
>
> He took such that he could carry by himself, the rest he let be
> Then he beat the kettledrums of departure and raised the flag
>
> He set out with one thousand and five hundred
> Of his own tribe, and went towards Khulm by way of Bamiyan[107]

News of Dost Mohammad's flight arrived in the British camp on 3 August 1839. It took only three more days for the army to march the final few miles to Kabul. On 7 August, eight months after they had left Ferozepur, the Army of the Indus finally marched into the Afghan capital with Shah Shuja at its head, 'dazzling in a coronet, jewelled girdle and bracelet', and Macnaghten not to be outdone in 'a cocked hat fringed with ostrich feathers, a blue frock coat with raised buttons, richly embroidered on the collar and cuffs, epaulettes not yielding in splendour to those of a field marshal, and trousers edged in very broad gold lace'. It was thirty years since the Shah had last seen his magnificent Timurid palace on the great rock of the Bala Hisar, which occupied nearly a quarter of the area of Kabul. Silent crowds filled the street, standing up as the Shah passed, and reseating themselves as the British officials followed; but there were no cheers and no rejoicing. According to George Lawrence, the Kabulis showed 'the most complete indifference [at the return of the Shah], expressing no sign of welcome or satisfaction at his accession to the throne. Evidently their hearts and affections were with their previous sovereign, now a wanderer beyond the Hindu Kush.'[108] Another young officer went further. 'It was more like a funeral procession', he wrote, 'than the entry of a king into the capital of his restored dominions.'[109]